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# Ralph Sutton

*Pianist Ralph Sutton was born in 1922 in Hamburg, Missouri. He spent much of his early career with Jack Teagarden, becoming a fixture at Eddie Condon's in New York. His friendship with Fats Waller influenced his own piano style and his recreations of stride and ragtime are well respected. Ralph has recorded frequently for the Riverside, Verve and Commodore labels, and is comfortable in both the solo piano and combo settings. Ralph can be heard at numerous jazz parties and festivals both here and abroad.*

*Ralph was interviewed by Monk Rowe at Hamilton College on September 22, 1995. Bob Haggart also participated in part of the interview.*

MR: We are filming today for the Hamilton Jazz Archive and we are very pleased to have pianist Ralph Sutton with us today, who is on campus for what I'm sure will be a marvelous concert with a great cast of people that we'll talk about in a while. We appreciate your joining us for an interview, and I understand that you started out with Jack Teagarden years ago? Is that right? Was that your first kind of entry into the music business?

RS: No, I started out when I was nine years old.

MR: When you were nine.

RS: Studying piano through grade school, high school, and part college. I was in college when I joined Jack Teagarden when I was 19. I went from a Missouri farm boy to New York City, it scared me to death.

MR: Was that culture shock or what?

RS: I don't know. It was a shock, I don't know how much culture was involved. So that's how I got to know Jack.

MR: In Missouri, what kind of music did you hear as a child growing up?

RS: Well there was a radio station in St. Louis, and they had a little program on there called "Harlem Rhythm," a 15 minute program every morning. And that's how I got started hearing Duke Ellington, Basie, and Fastolo Wolloro.

MR: You can expand on that.

RS: Well that's Fats Waller. And I mentioned coming over today, Fats — Rochester was interviewing Fats one time and, "what is this thing, what kind of music you playing, Fats, this thing is swing or what?" Well Fats says, "You get that right tickin' rhythm man and it's on."

MR: Figure that out right? The right ticking rhythm.

RS: Not, he didn't put the "G" on it. The right tickin' rhythm, man, it's on.

MR: You do that pretty well. You say that pretty well. When you were growing up and you were listening to that, was the music called, did it have a name? Was it called swing? Was it called jazz?

RS: No, I think the laymen, the guys that couldn't play anything and just listened, they had to put labels on things to understand what the guys were playing. But the musicians didn't need to call it anything, you know.

MR: I think it was the same thing when bop started. I think I read that the critics called it bop. The musicians just played it.

RS: Yeah.

MR: How did you move from — what particular circumstance took you from Missouri to New York?

RS: Well Jack Teagarden sent a telegram to the school. I was going to college in Kirksville, Missouri. And he sent a telegram. Well he'd been through and played a dance in the armory building in Kirksville, and I didn't have the money to get in to hear Jack you know, but I knew Jack I mean through a couple of movies he'd been in, and I loved Jack's playing. And I had to get in to see him. So there happened to be a window open downstairs in the armory building, and I found that it was unlocked and I got through that way and got upstairs you know, and mixed with the customers. And I sat in —

MR: You sat in? That night?

RS: Yeah. Because some kids in the audience said, "Hey Jack, we've got a piano player here." And I'm shrinking back, I don't want to — but anyway, Jack says, "Come on up." He says, "What do you want to play, Gate?" And I said I think my dad's favorite tune "Back Home in Indiana." So that's how I — and then a month later he sent a telegram to the school, trying to locate a piano — this was back during World War II and he was losing musicians. And so they located me and I answered right back.

MR: "I think I'll come" right?

RS: I quit school and everything.

MR: That's a great story and so many of the musicians we talked to have little stories like that, that kind of really turned their lives in one direction or another. Like you chose to sneak through that window that night, and look what happened.

RS: That's right.

MR: Did you ever pay him for the ticket though?

RS: Pardon?

MR: Did you ever pay him for the ticket?

RS: Oh, for the armory? No. I didn't have any money.

MR: And it's really interesting how big a part that the radio played back at that time.

RS: Right.

MR: Everyone has mentioned that they listened to it. Their first exposure to a lot of this music was the radio.

RS: Radio was much better then than television is today you know. Really. I won't go into it.

MR: Yeah, I know. We could do a whole hour on that probably. So when you got to New York, how long did you stay with that group?

RS: I was with Jack about three months and then I was drafted in the Army.

MR: Okay, that was my next question. You did do the Army thing.

RS: Yeah.

MR: Did you do music in the Army?

RS: Well I tried to get in the band. But they needed cannon fodder. They put me in the infantry. And I went through basic training and then I ended up in the 104th Division and I got in a band with the 104th Division. I was playing glockenspiel in the marching band.

MR: I was going to ask, because a couple of other piano players have mentioned that they had to play something they could get out on the field with.

RS: Yeah.

MR: The glockenspiel. And how long were you in the Army for?

RS: About two and a half years.

MR: As soon as you could get out.

RS: Yeah.

MR: That's interesting. And how about after that?

RS: I got out of the Army and let's see, I was down in the Mojave Desert on maneuvers. I ended up in Colorado Springs at the Camp Carson. And that's where I got my discharge. And I took the train back to St. Louis from Colorado Springs, and my first job was in East St. Louis at a place called Bowman's. It was a restaurant, and they had gambling in Illinois then. So that was my first job, playing piano in this restaurant.

MR: Can you tell us how the lessons you took as a child, what other kind of learning you had to do to become someone who could play with Teagarden and also do solo piano?

RS: Well when I was going to high school, my dad started a little country band. He played the violin by ear. And he got a group together and we used to play country dances and picnics, church picnics, and things like that. And that's how I started playing it.

MR: So that's when you got to start to develop your ear for learning songs more by ear than—

RS: Well we'd buy the sheet music. Thirty-five cents a copy. And you'd learn the tunes that way.

MR: Did you learn chord symbols, to read from chord symbols at that time?

RS: No I just read from the music. The chord symbols above it, I didn't pay any attention. I think it was for the guitar player or something.

MR: Yeah. But when you went with Teagarden, there had to be a certain amount of playing by—

RS: Arrangements. He had a big band. And that's what the piano player did, hopefully.

MR: So it really was important to be able to read.

RS: Oh, yeah, well I did that from the beginning you know.

MR: What was your next, what you consider to be your next important engagement perhaps, after that?

RS: Well I worked around St. Louis, in the Chase Hotel, in the Park Plaza. I was on staff, one of the musicians of the radio station. I'll never forget the guy that had the band on this radio station, his name was Carl Hoengarden. And he started Gordon Jenkins out. Gordon was from a suburb of St. Louis, and he started Gordon Jenkins out. And he used to write, we used to play behind a singer on this radio station, Jackie Hill. And Carl would do the arrangements and conduct the group, the band, and he wrote in some tough keys man, there would be a lot of black specs on that paper.

MR: Was that because it was for a singer?

RS: Yeah, we played behind a singer.

MR: Yeah, I know. It seems like every time you get behind a singer you end up with too many flats.

RS: Furnished or unfurnished.

MR: That's a good one.

RS: And from then, I did that for about two and a half years and then I re-joined Jack Teagarden, he was going into the Famous Door on 52nd Street. And in the band he had Max Kaminsky, Jack Lesberg, Peanuts Hucko, Eddie Shaughnessy on drums and myself on piano.

MR: You know, Ed Shaughnessy mentioned that engagement to us.

RS: Did he?

MR: We talked to him in Los Angeles. And that must have been one of his first I think really memorable engagements for him.

RS: Well Eddie is from New York isn't he?

MR: Yeah. He's from that area and he told us this story about how he got his first drumset and then he used to go into New York and go into all the clubs. And he mentioned that engagement, that he felt that that was really where he started to feel like yeah, I can do this, this is great. What was 52nd Street and that area of New York like at that time?

RS: It was swinging.

MR: It's swinging.

RS: Oh, yeah. All the clubs, two sides of the street you know, on that side and this side. Gee, Art Tatum was playing there, and I'm trying to think. Well this was about the time too

when Jack got together with Louis Armstrong and they had the Louis Armstrong All-Stars. And I'll never forget the night I went with Jack in a taxicab over to the Town Hall where they did the, it was a Louis Armstrong concert, well he had Bobby Hackett and I think Bob Haggart played on that. And Dick Cary was playing piano, and Sid Catlett, and Peanuts was on that too. That was recorded for RCA Victor. But I'll never forget, I was sitting up in the balcony looking right down at all the guys you know. And I'm getting goose bumps you know, listening to all that wonderful music. Well from there on I, that's when Jack and Louis and the All-Stars with Barney Bigard and Big Sid, that's when that started, and then I lost my job after Jack went with Louie, and of course I didn't have a job. So I had to sweat out my union card too.

MR: Can you explain that? What that meant?

RS: Well you had to spend so much time in the area, in the city. You could take a job here and a job there, but you couldn't take a steady job for about three months or something like that, or I think it was six months before you got your card or something like that. I finally got it.

MR: To establish residency or something like that.

RS: Yeah. And I mean they really checked on you.

MR: Yeah. The union was not something to be trifled with at that time I guess. How much did it cost to join the union back then?

RS: I can't remember.

MR: It's a lot now.

RS: Is it?

MR: Yeah I think so, quite a bit now. So you had a reputation, at least you had on your resume that you played with Teagarden. Did that help you get your next engagement?

RS: Well I worked like at the Hickory House and the Village Vanguard. This was after I got my union card. The Embers, they used to call it "The Numbers," The Embers, and different spots before I went to work at Eddie Condon's in Greenwich Village. That was in 1948.

MR: Could you describe for our students who may be trying to put things in a historical perspective, what —

RS: Hysterical or historical?

MR: That too. Was it hysterical back then?

RS: Oh we had a few laughs.

MR: What was it like to make as living as a jazz musician back at that time? Without getting personal about how much you made and everything, but was it a life that you felt was what you really wanted. Was it easy? Was it hard?

RS: Both. Times when you'd run out of money it'd be hard. But well the times were different then and it always seemed like you'd get a job someplace, maybe a one-nighter someplace. You'd go out of New York, or you'd get it in New York City, why it seemed like all the guys were getting along real fine. You know, there was no — we'd just play for the enjoyment, too. There was nothing uptight about anything as far as I was concerned. It could be that way nowadays I guess.

MR: Yeah, they say the scene has changed a lot. There's not as many places to play I guess.

RS: There was a lot of enjoyment then you know.

MR: And sharing of ideas?

RS: Sure.

MR: Now I know Fats Waller was an influence on your playing, is that a fair statement?

RS: That's right. Yeah, I've loved Fats from the beginning of my musical experience when I started at nine and he'll be with me until I'm gone.

MR: He wrote some great tunes too.

RS: Oh, he was a wonderful musician. I always liked what Fats said, he said, "I was born balling, and I'm gonna have a ball as long as I live."

MR: What a character. Who else were some people you listened to and maybe grabbed a little bit of influence from?

RS: Well I played with a lot of different guys that are gone now, they've died. But I've learned from so many of the guys on different instruments you know?

MR: Right, not just piano.

RS: Yeah, that's right, sure. You try to keep your ears open.

MR: Good statement. I'd like to quote you on that. Keep your ears open. Yeah. When you fellows play tonight and tomorrow, if you had a put a name, a style of what it is you do. Would you call it something? Now we were in L.A. and we heard the Classic Jazz Festival. Is that what you would call it? Or wouldn't you call it anything?

RS: I wouldn't call it anything. I always like what Eddie Condon says, we call it music. That's the way I explain it.

MR: Yeah, it's hard. Because people ask me well Classic Jazz, what does that mean? And is it different from Dixieland and —

RS: And who gave these names to all these different kinds of music you hear? It's the layman.

MR: Right. I guess we have to ask the critics then.

RS: You know, the critics, that's another thing.

MR: Talk about critics.

RS: Well you could, I often thought I could be a critic's critic.

MR: Right. You could start writing articles about the critics. What is it that annoys you about them?

RS: Well, they couldn't make a living — if they played an instrument, they couldn't make a living playing. So they have to —

MR: They have to write about it. Yeah. How much — have you been able to do some traveling around outside the country in some of the groups you've played?

RS: Quite a bit. Australia, Japan, Europe, Great Britain. I'll never forget when I was with Bob Haggart and Yank Lawson, and it was with a band, it was called the World's Greatest Jazz Band. Of course none of the musicians named it that, it was a guy that started, that got the thing together with the help of Bob Haggart and Yank Lawson, they called it the World's Greatest Jazz Band. I'll never forget one time we were playing in Honolulu, and then we came back and played one night in San Francisco at a place called Earthquake Magoon's, and the next day we get on a plane and we fly up to Alaska. You know that was quite a hop. And for a one-night concert.

MR: I guess so.

RS: Then back to the States.

MR: For one-nighters like that.

BH: And you were in Palm Springs right after that, remember?

RS: That's right.

BH: That was the party at The Thunderbird.

RS: Right. That was a football players birthday party, wasn't it? Remember that?

BH: Well Hoagy and Phil Harris were there.

RS: That's right. I remember that. We got Hoagy on the piano.

BH: As soon as we walked in the place, these women members of the Thunderbird Club said, "Now don't let Hoagy and Phil sit in tonight." The first thing they said. We were just walking in the place in the afternoon. They were all ready for us. Because they were on the bad list, see? Hoagy and Phil did some naughty things in front of the whole membership. The women objected, you see.

MR: But they ended up playing anyhow?

BH: Then came in anyhow, and sat in.

RS: Hoagy, on the piano, with Phil Harris sitting in on drums.

BH: Sitting in on drums, yes.

RS: And he went over backwards, didn't he?

BH: Yeah, he got off the stand and fell right down, smack, on the table. Crashing down on one of the tables in front of the bandstand.

RS: Having a few tastes that night.

BH: He got his foot caught in a wire, you know, a microphone wire. And he went crashing down.

MR: Another point for his reputation.

RS: It broke up the party. Don Hudson. Was that the football player?

BH: I don't remember the football player.

MR: What was different, is there a difference playing overseas, with the audiences?

RS: For me there is. I mean I enjoy that a lot, to play in England, Scotland. I just had a tour of England, Scotland and Ireland last month. But it seems like there's a different sort of warm appreciation. They really make you feel good.

MR: Great. When you go to those places, in recent years, who are your band mates that you like to—

RS: I usually go by myself.

MR: Oh, you play solo?

RS: Well no I join up with the guys wherever I go.

MR: See that's a concept that is really interesting I think to students. The idea of going across the seas and you don't know who you're going to play with. And the number of songs that you have to have at your disposal. I mean if you're in Ireland for instance, what kinds of songs do you expect those musicians to be able to know?

RS: I don't expect anything.

MR: You don't expect anything.

RS: No. Sometimes I'll play solo when I go in, or this last trip in, not Belfast but the other one, okay, anyway—

MR: Dublin?

RS: That's it. I played with they had two pianists this one night, two pianists. And a bass man and a drummer. So that's how that worked out.

MR: And you call a tune and hope they know it or they say—

RS: No they'd say how about playing this? Okay. Or if you don't know that, or maybe I don't know it. You know so it's not that hard. Everything falls into place.

MR: But it's still interesting, I think, for classical musicians too, to think how that works. I don't know if a classical, if you got three classical musicians together, if they could play enough songs from memory. You know, shall we play a Haydn sonata, or—

RS: They'd better bring the music for it.

MR: They would probably bring the music, yeah.

RS: That would help.

MR: How has the business of jazz changed for you over the years?

RS: Changed for me?

MR: Has it changed for you or has it been fairly consistent?

RS: It's been fairly consistent I think.

MR: Has the style that you play in, do you feel that that has, is it something that you think that other people have picked up on. Do you think that you've influenced other players?

RS: I don't know.

MR: You don't know, but I'll bet you have.

RS: I really don't know.

MR: Who do you listen to these days? Do you spend a lot of time listening to music?

RS: No.

MR: I know that a lot of musicians don't maybe listen as much as maybe some non-musicians. It's like when it's your actual work.

RS: Not it's not my actual work.

MR: It's not your actual work?

RS: You wouldn't call it work, would you? Playing?

MR: I would call it work. Yeah. Maybe if you're going to call it employment, you know, it's how you make your living.

RS: I've never thought of it that way.

MR: Never thought of it as work, that's great. That's really great.

RS: It's a pleasure.

MR: It's a pleasure. Your employment is a pleasure. See not many people—

RS: As long as you're playing with the guys that you like. But I avoid playing with people I don't like. That wouldn't be any fun, would it?

MR: No it wouldn't. It's nice to have the liberty I guess, to be able to say, no I'd rather not do that.

RS: Well you have to make up your own mind about — you might play one night with a guy and you never want to hear this cat again, you know what I mean? You stay away from it. Avoid it.

MR: Who are some of the singers that you've played behind that you enjoyed.

RS: Jimmy Rushing. He was one of my favorites. Well Jack Teagarden sang. I remember working at the Village Vanguard behind Maxine Sullivan, who I adored. And there's another girl singer, Chippy Hill, yeah. But Lee Wiley, I remember I played behind her at the Village Vanguard with Max Kaminsky and Arthur Trappier, he took Slick Jones' place on drums with Fats Waller. We were working as a trio at the Vanguard and Lee Wiley was married to Jess Stacey at the time. And she came in, she was on the show at the Village Vanguard. And I don't whether she and Jess were getting along too well or not, but you could never get that tempo right for Lee Wiley you know? We'd have a rehearsal and she'd want to sing at this tempo, and I'd try to set the tempo I remember like she liked to sing it. And she'd turn around you know and give you a look, and I'm

thinking, I'm going to stay away from singers, man. But anyway, I loved Lee singing you know. I'll never forget her coming into Eddie Condon's club later on. I can't say what our conversation was about, I mean we were very friendly. But she sort of apologized to me for being very sarcastic sometimes on the job you know. But we settled it. There was no problem.

MR: Yeah, working with singers can be a little nerve wracking occasionally. Especially if you hit a chord they don't particularly like and it throws them off, and you get one of those looks.

RS: I always thought for the most part that you couldn't compare singers with musicians, you know what I mean? You work with a wonderful guy like Jimmy Rushing or Jack Teagarden or somebody singing, there was no problems at all, it was right in there you know. But it didn't always work you know.

MR: Yeah. I think it probably helps when a singer is a player of an instrument.

RS: Yeah, and knows what's going on.

MR: They are able to hear and deal with little things that come up a little more gracefully. When a singer stops, that's when you start going ohhh—

RS: I'll never forget, this reminds me of a story. One time I'm playing in St. Louis and it was at a fashion show, and they had this gal singer on, oh this goes back in the '40s. And this gal was singing, and I'm accompanying her, and she turned around and gave me some stuff like, you know. Well this was something I wouldn't take. I just got off the piano and walked away and said, "Okay, go ahead and sing," you know?

MR: I'll bet she didn't give the next person she played with the same look. You probably saved someone else some embarrassment down the road.

RS: Yeah.

MR: Now you have seen a lot of styles in music come and go. Some of them have come and stayed. Can you tell us what some of the changes were in music that you really enjoyed, or some that you did not enjoy? Was there anything that happened since the '40s that has really been you think significant for you, as far as changes in music? Either positively or negatively?

RS: Would you repeat that?

MR: Well I'm thinking of, how did the rock & roll revolution if you want to call it that, effect your employment? Did it have any effect on what you did?

RS: Well you don't make the same kind of money that rock & rollers made. But I've never paid any attention to it, because I never listened to it, and it doesn't interest me. Simple as that.

MR: Just did your own thing.

RS: There's only two kinds of music you know?

MR: Tell us.

RS: Good and bad. I always try to stick on the one side.

MR: Stick on the one side and play with the good guys too.

RS: Yeah.

MR: Did the end of World War II have an effect on the musicians' lives that that time? When swing the Swing Era kind of ended — can I say it ended after World War II in effect, when the big bands had such a hard time keeping on the road and so forth? Or were you more working in smaller groups at that point?

RS: The only big band I worked with was with Jack Teagarden. So it used to be you know you turned the radio on and you'd hear big bands broadcasting from all over you know. But that faded out and well you did have the records to listen to. And things changed, they had smaller groups, trios, you worked in a trio or a quartet or a six or seven piece band, nine piece band. But I didn't pay too much attention. I just kept doing my own thing.

MR: Doing your own thing. Can you tell us what a recording session was like back when you were with Teagarden or some of those days, what a recording session involved as far as the time and so forth? Because we read about nowadays with some of the groups how they have huge budgets and they spend months making an album. What was it like back then when you were able to record?

RS: We went and did the record date, and I don't know a record session would be like two and a half hours or something like that for a date. And it was much simpler. I mean and now with all the noise going on it takes them months to do it.

MR: Did you get paid a union session fee?

RS: Union scale. I think it was like — what was the union scale, Bob, 47 bucks for a record date?

BH: $41.25.

MR: He's got a pretty good memory.

BH: Before that it was $30. And it went up to $41.25. And now it's, I think it's like 500 bucks for an album for two sessions.

MR: And how long can a session be?

BH: Three hours. And then after that it's overtime, whatever that comes to.

MR: When was the last recording you did? It was a solo recording? I have some of your solo work.

RS: No, the last one was this year in July I think. I did it in New York for Mat Domber. Jake Hanna was on drums and Rosemary Galloway was on bass. It was a trio date.

MR: He's got a nice label there. Arbors Records.

RS: Yeah. And he's a nice guy too.

MR: He sure is. We saw him out in L.A. It's really great to have you gentlemen on campus, to be able to play, what you're going to play tonight, which we won't put a name to, because I think it'll just be good music. And if you had a young friend who was going to go into music as a career, was considering it, would you have anything to tell them to keep in mind along the way? Other than, "Don't quit your day gig?"

RS: No, well the first thing you have to do, you have to enjoy what you do. You have to enjoy what you do and love it. And I think if you enjoy it, that'll take care of itself, you know what I mean? You've got to enjoy it first and have fun with it. Otherwise you're going through life—

MR: I've got a feeling from what you've said today that that has been something that's actually guided you through your life.

RS: Right.

MR: Like I'm not enjoying this, so I'm not going to do this. That's a great philosophy.

RS: Yeah.

MR: It's nice to hear that you're able to do that. Because I think for a lot of people, they're not able to have that as an issue. It's more like, I'm not enjoying this but this is what I have to do — or I have to do this to either make a living — or some people might not have goals as set as perhaps you did you know, that they didn't really know what they wanted to do.

RS: It's possible, but it would be tough. It would really be tough, you know what I mean?

MR: It would be a hard life.

RS: I refuse to do things that I don't want to do. Why? You've got your own life. Look out after yourself, and have a good philosophy about life, you know what I mean?

MR: Is there a particular gig, or series of gigs that you can remember that was like, man, one of the real highlights of your career?

RS: Well I enjoyed playing with Bob Haggart and Yank Lawson in that band. That was a good band.

MR: Yeah. It just about lived up to the title of that band.

RS: Right. But we didn't give it that title.

MR: Right, I understand that.

RS: But we had a great band. And a guy sent me a tape, a cassette, from Minneapolis. We played in a place, oh this goes back to the early '70s. And we played a place outside of Minneapolis, called the Emporium of Jazz. And the band was Benny Morton on trombone, Yank Lawson, Billy Butterfield, Bud Freeman, Bob Wilber, Gus Johnson on drums, Bob Haggart and myself. And he recorded it one night when we were playing in there. And he sent me this tape. And I hadn't heard it. And I'm going to the airport with my wife. We put the thing in and played this, and I couldn't believe it man, it gave me goose pimples.

MR: It was hot huh? It was swinging?

RS: Oh, man. It had that right tickin' rhythm. Everybody was playing. The joint was jumping. And Gus Johnson on drums man. One of the greatest drummers I ever worked with. Really. He was right with it. We used to work, Gus and I used to work up in Billings, Montana in a hotel up there. Just the two of us. So I gave us the names of Frick and Frack. And we'd go up there for a four week engagement you know. Play six nights a week, off the seventh, so we'd be in somebody's home. Gus would do the cooking and I'd make my hot sauce.

MR: Oh, great. Improvising in the kitchen.

RS: Yeah. Switchin' in the kitchen.

MR: You must have developed quite a good left hand when you were working with just a drummer and no bass player, huh? Did you?

RS: Well I had that going anyway.

MR: Yeah. That's been part of your playing.

RS: Well that was from, when I was a kid, listening to Fats Waller. Look, he covered that thing man.

MR: That's a hard style, that stride.

RS: Maybe it is, but if you love it and like it, then it's not hard.

MR: Well, that's been a great philosophy: love it and like it and if you don't like it, don't do it.

RS: That's right.

MR: I think I'm going to live that way from now on.

RS: Why not, man? It's the best way.

MR: All right.

RS: You've got to have a little stubbornness in there to see that it goes that way.

MR: Yeah. And next time a singer looks at me like that, I'm going to remember what you did. I don't know if I'd have the nerve to do it.

RS: Why not?

MR: You didn't want to work with her again anyway, right?

RS: No, and I don't either.

MR: Before we wrap up, you just mentioned playing at a fashion show. You know it's interesting the kind of things that people don't maybe think about, where you have played, you know different functions that you've played for. Has there been one thing that you could recollect that was like a real oddball type of gig that you played? That's a hard question I know.

RS: I'd have to give that some thought.

MR: Most people have them, but you kind of put them back here so they're not—

RS: I'd have to think that over. I can't come up with it.

MR: Okay, well Part II with Ralph Sutton. We'll get into that. Well I'm looking forward to the concert tonight.

RS: We're going to have some fun.

MR: You're going to have some fun. You've got a great group coming in with Scott Hamilton and Warren Vache, and of course Bob Haggart who we're going to talk with, and Kenny Davern, and Bobby Rosengarden. That's quite a cast. So on behalf of Hamilton College Jazz Archive, I want to thank Ralph Sutton for joining us today. It's been a real pleasure, and I enjoyed your philosophy on life and music. And thanks for your time.

RS: Yeah, man, thank you.